BRIAN KEARNEY

Senior DevOps & Platform Engineer

OpenShift • Kubernetes • Ansible • Python • IBM DataPower / API Connect • Vault & PKI

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Senior DevOps and platform engineer with 20+ years of hands-on experience building, migrating, and operating critical infrastructure for Fortune 100 companies in healthcare, financial services, and automotive. Led the IBM DataPower and API Connect migration to Red Hat OpenShift at CVS Health / Aetna, moving hundreds of appliances and services onto OpenShift on VMware, Azure, and GCP. Now building fleet monitoring and reproducible GPU site installs for a computer-vision company serving US hospitals, and presented the Project Catalyst agent-security demo at IBM TechXchange 2026. US Army veteran, and the engineer you bring in when the problem is half technical, half organizational, and the solution has to survive an audit.

CORE TECHNICAL SKILLS

Cloud & Containers: Red Hat OpenShift, Kubernetes (k3s, kubeadm), Helm, Docker / Compose, VMware, Microsoft Azure, Google Cloud (GCP Compute), AWS ECR

Automation & IaC: Ansible (playbooks, roles, modules), Terraform / OpenTofu, Python, Django / DRF, Bash, GitLab CI, Jenkins, CI/CD, GitOps

API & Integration: IBM DataPower, IBM API Connect (APIC), API gateway design, REST APIs, FastAPI, nginx, OAuth, mTLS

Identity & Security: Keycloak (OIDC, RBAC), HashiCorp Vault / OpenBao, cert-manager, PKI and certificate lifecycle automation, SSO, Kerberos

AI / Agent Infrastructure: Claude Code, MCP (Model Context Protocol), rossoctl, BeeAI Agent Stack (Linux Foundation), LLM platforms, RAG patterns

Observability: Splunk, fleet monitoring agents, log management, monitoring dashboards, incident response, SRE practices

Platforms & Hardware: Linux administration (RHEL, Fedora, Ubuntu), Lima VMs, NVIDIA GPU drivers, Axis / ONVIF cameras

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Owner & Managing Member — Mar 2012 – Present

McIndi Solutions, LLC | Hackettstown, NJ (Remote)

Boutique IT consultancy, founded in 2012 and now solely owned, delivering automation, platform engineering, and integration work in regulated industries. The engagements below were delivered through McIndi.

- Run all business operations: client and staffing-firm contracts, invoicing and finance, insurance and compliance, software licensing (a Big Four firm licensed MAST for IBM DataPower from 2015 to 2026), and placing McIndi engineers on engagements
- Won McIndi's longest-running account, IBM DataPower managed engineering for a care-management platform serving Blue Cross Blue Shield plans (2017 – present), and led the initial implementation
- Delivered shorter DataPower and Splunk engagements for Horizon BCBSNJ, CareCentrix, NJ Manufacturers, and Chemours

Senior DevOps & Integrations Builder — Aug 2026 – Present

Hospital Computer-Vision Company | Remote | Contract via McIndi Solutions

Own fleet monitoring, GPU site installs, storage, and infrastructure standards for a camera-based supply-chain platform.

- Built and maintain the fleet monitoring and security platform: a lightweight Python agent on Ubuntu and Red Hat hosts reporting over pinned TLS to a FastAPI server behind nginx.
- Added certificate-expiry monitoring, configuration drift detection, job inventory, security-update reporting, zero-touch enrollment, and camera health checks. Wrote the production, staging, and dev runbooks.
- Made the GPU inference application's site install reproducible with a verified rebuild runbook and a single-entry-point install bundle, and led a full GPU test rebuild toward hands-free automation.
- Led a storage review covering inventory, retention, de-duplication, and tiering, and identified reclaimable space across production systems.
- Wrote infrastructure standards, architecture decision records, identity and secrets-management proposals, and jump-host configuration as Ansible.
- Designed an approval-gated, AI-assisted engineering workflow in which every outbound message, production change, and credential use requires explicit human approval.

Senior Developer & Team Anchor, IT Modernization & Cloud Migration — Aug 2019 – Dec 2024

CVS Health / Aetna | Remote | Contract via McIndi Solutions

Led the migration of IBM DataPower and API Connect (APIC) infrastructure to Red Hat OpenShift across VMware, Azure, and GCP for a Fortune 50 healthcare enterprise, as senior engineer on an 8-member Agile team delivering migration automation and net-new platform deployment.

- Reduced deployment time by 50% and improved service uptime by leading Ansible automation (playbooks and roles for migration and net-new deployment) of DataPower and APIC services on OpenShift

- Built a custom Python framework for real-time monitoring and operational troubleshooting of 300+ DataPower appliances across the enterprise, reducing mean time to resolution by 40%
- Implemented HashiCorp Vault for enterprise secrets management supporting DataPower/APIC and OpenShift services, including integration with Azure Key Vault across the hybrid on-prem/Azure environment
- Mentored 4 junior developers in automation, system design, and CI/CD patterns, cutting onboarding time

IBM API Connect & DataPower Consultant Nov 2022 – Jun 2024

CareFirst BlueCross BlueShield | Contract via McIndi Solutions and iSOA Group

- Upgraded API Connect to v10.0.5.x and migrated v5-compatible APIs to the DataPower API Gateway
- Built Ansible automation for DataPower configuration and filestore management

DataPower & Security Automation Consultant, Access Control & Data Protection Mar 2019 – Dec 2022

Big Four Professional Services Firm | Contract via McIndi Solutions and iSOA Group

Two engagements, from March 2019 to April 2020 and from January to December 2022.

- Strengthened authentication, authorization, and audit controls by designing and managing the automation of enterprise-wide encryption standard updates with Python, Django, and IBM DataPower
- Reduced manual intervention by 80% by designing and managing a secure REST API (Django REST Framework) for the creation, testing, and deployment of Kerberos keytabs
- Cut implementation time for complex API integrations from 6 months to 3 weeks by delivering a custom “low-code” framework for IBM DataPower services
- Reduced mean time to resolution by 40% by leading a cross-functional team to enhance Splunk-based enterprise monitoring with custom dashboards for infrastructure health

DataPower & Splunk Consultant Jun 2014 – Mar 2019

JM Family Enterprises | Remote (Deerfield Beach, FL) | Contract via McIndi Solutions and Signature Consultants

Ran the IBM DataPower integration tier behind the in-house systems JM Family’s dealer network uses to manage vehicle inventory, shipping, and receiving, covering preventative maintenance, incident response, and integration requirements for new services.

- Led the DataPower firmware upgrade project ahead of the June 2016 end-of-support date and laid out vendor-support options for management to cover the cutover
- Introduced Splunk monitoring for the DataPower tier, including SNMP MIBs and DB Connect to DB2 on z/OS
- Wrote Python tooling for DataPower certificate export and audit, and grew the engagement into a McIndi DataPower team

DataPower Infrastructure Consultant May 2013 – Mar 2015

Big Four Professional Services Firm | IBM Software Services subcontract via Infinite Computer Solutions

- Took over the client’s DataPower infrastructure support from IBM Software Services under the client SLA, covering XI52 appliance service requests and weekly status reports

SPEAKING

IBM TechXchange 2026, Atlanta Oct 2026

Session TEC-2557: Beyond the Proof-of-Concept: The Architecture of Accountable Agentic AI Governance, with iSOA Group and IBM

- Presented the Project Catalyst demo and co-led Q&A: Keycloak OIDC and SPIFFE/SPIRE identity, Vault just-in-time secrets, AuthBridge egress control, and intent-based access control blocking a prompt-injected tool call, audited in SIEMatic.
- Built an Ansible-provisioned arm64 edition of the full Catalyst stack: kubeadm, CRI-O, and Calico on Fedora 44 under Lima; rossoctl v0.7.0 with TLS, MCP Gateway, Phoenix, and Ollama; OpenBao with Vault Secrets Operator; and SIEMatic from multi-arch images. Fresh install in about 11 minutes; cold start in 171 seconds.

IBM Impact 2011, Las Vegas | Session 1335: DataPower monitoring, co-presented with Jim Brennan 2011

FEATURED OPEN-SOURCE PROJECTS

Project Armory github.com/McIndi/project-armory: open-source secure Kubernetes platform foundation for running AI agents in regulated enterprises. k3s with the API server OIDC-integrated to Keycloak, secrets and PKI via OpenBao, Vault Secrets Operator, and cert-manager with a private CA and no plaintext secrets in Git, provisioned end to end with Ansible.

Project Garrison github.com/McIndi/project-garrison: deploys the BeeAI Agent Stack (Linux Foundation) onto Armory via Ansible, with automated Keycloak provisioning, OpenBao-backed secrets, a Postgres/pgvector backend, and OAuth/PKCE CLI authentication.

EARLIER EXPERIENCE

Technical Specialist | Express Scripts Holding Co. (now Cigna), Franklin Lakes, NJ 2011 – 2012

Infrastructure Architect | Medco Health Solutions (acquired by Express Scripts), Franklin Lakes, NJ 2002 – 2011

Light Wheeled Vehicle Mechanic | United States Army (honorably discharged) 1994 – 2002